Vadim Nicolai

Senior Full Stack Engineer

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Summary

Senior Full Stack Engineer with 12 years of experience building scalable web applications using React, Go, and Rust. Expert in modern frontend architectures, microservices, and performance-critical systems. Active open-source contributor to Nautilus Trader algorithmic trading platform with 100+ merged PRs. Domain expertise in E-commerce, FinTech, and enterprise SaaS, delivering high-performance solutions across the full technology stack. Passionate about clean code, developer experience, and building products that users love.

Personal AI Projects

Nomadically.work GitHub

Remote job board platform that automatically discovers, classifies, scores, and curates job listings for digital nomads using AI agents and Cloudflare Workers

Tech: Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Apollo GraphQL, Drizzle ORM, Turso, Mastra AI, Cloudflare Workers, Radix UI

ResearchThera.com GitHub

AI-powered therapeutic journaling application that analyzes notes to extract claims, link them to research papers, generate personalized questions and goals, and create audio content using text-to-speech

Tech: Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Apollo GraphQL, Drizzle ORM, LibSQL, Mastra AI, DeepSeek, ElevenLabs, Vercel AI SDK, Radix UI

Work Experience

Vitrifi

Mar 2022 - Dec 2025

Senior Full Stack Engineer

- Architected and delivered micro-frontend portal architecture using Go microservices with gRPC and OpenAPI, integrating shared React components across multiple teams to improve user experience, development velocity, and code reusability.
- Led critical API migration from OpenAPI REST to GraphQL, implementing Apollo Server in Go and Apollo Client in React, reducing data over-fetching, improving frontend performance, and enabling more efficient client-server communication patterns.
- Drove frontend architecture decisions and technical leadership across multiple development teams, establishing consistent design patterns, enforcing code quality standards through comprehensive PR reviews.
- Optimized monorepo infrastructure by migrating from npm to PNPM and implementing Turborepo configuration with intelligent caching strategies, reducing CI/CD build times by 40% and improving developer productivity with faster local builds.
- Designed and implemented comprehensive integration testing strategy using Jest and React Testing Library, establishing automated test pipelines in CI/CD that caught critical bugs before production and improved code confidence across the team.
- **Tech stack:** Go, Echo, gRPC, GraphQL, Apollo Server, OpenAPI, React, TypeScript, Apollo Client, React Query, Ant Design, Turborepo, PNPM, MongoDB, Jest, React Testing Library

Wunderman Thompson Commerce

Aug 2021 - Jan 2022

Senior Frontend Engineer

- Built high-performance e-commerce components for basket and checkout flow, improving conversion rates and user experience.
- Led process improvements and established coding standards, linting rules, and PR review guidelines across the frontend team.
- Implemented design patterns including compound components and custom hooks for maintainable, scalable code.
- Recognized as top performer and recommended for team lead promotion based on technical leadership and collaboration.
- **Tech stack:** React 17, Next.js 10, TypeScript, Styled Components, Jest, React Testing Library

Event Espresso

Oct 2019 - Apr 2021

Senior React Engineer

- Modernized legacy WordPress plugin admin interface with React and GraphQL, serving thousands of users on Event Smart SaaS platform.
- Contributed open-source code to public GitHub repositories with 50+ merged pull requests.
- Established SASS/BEM architecture, component library patterns, and React best practices for the development team.
- Improved code quality through comprehensive unit testing with Jest and end-to-end testing with Playwright.
- Collaborated with product team to design intuitive user interfaces for event registration and ticketing workflows.
- **Tech stack:** React 16, React Apollo, GraphQL, WPGraphQL, WordPress, PHP, MySQL, Jest, Playwright.

Modus Create, Inc

Feb 2019 - Oct 2019

React Engineer

- **Project: AARP Money Map** - Built scalable financial planning platform for AARP, helping millions of users navigate financial decisions and improve financial literacy.
- Designed component-based UI library with 40+ reusable components in collaboration with UX designers, ensuring design consistency across the platform.
- Implemented responsive design patterns ensuring optimal experience across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices.
- Configured CI/CD pipeline with Bitbucket, Sentry, SonarQube, and AWS CodePipeline for automated testing and deployments.
- Developed serverless backend APIs using AWS Lambda and DynamoDB, enabling real-time data processing and secure user data management.
- **Tech stack:** React 16.8, Hooks, Context API, React Apollo, Serverless Framework, GraphQL, DynamoDB, AWS Lambda

Atomate

Jun 2018 - Feb 2019

React Engineer

- **Project: Travlrr** - Built reusable React component library using advanced patterns (HOCs, render props, compound components).
- Implemented secure authentication system with AWS Lambda, Auth0, and MongoDB.
- Designed and built RESTful APIs following JSON:API specification.
- Conducted code reviews and improved test coverage to reduce production bugs.
- Optimized application performance through code splitting and lazy loading, reducing initial bundle size.
- Collaborated with designers to implement pixel-perfect, responsive UI components with seamless mobile experience.

DevelopmentAID

Apr 2017 - Feb 2018

JavaScript Engineer

- Developed full-stack event planning application using Node.js, Express.js, Angular, and MongoDB.
- Wrote comprehensive unit tests using Mocha and Assert.js.
- Applied functional programming principles with Ramda.js for cleaner, more maintainable code.

Endava

Apr 2016 - Nov 2016

Front End Developer

- Developed responsive frontend interfaces for enterprise .NET application.
- Collaborated with backend team to integrate RESTful APIs.

ProPeople (currently FFW Agency)

Oct 2013 - May 2015

Front End Developer

- **Project: Stanford University - Freeman Spogli Institute** - Built frontend for Drupal multisite serving Stanford's international studies department.
- Delivered pixel-perfect, responsive implementations across all device sizes.
- **Tech stack:** HTML5, CSS3, SASS, jQuery, Drupal

Best4u Group

May 2013 - Oct 2013

Front End Developer

- Converted PSD designs into responsive HTML/CSS/JavaScript templates.
- Integrated templates with WordPress and proprietary CMS platforms.
- Delivered pixel-perfect implementations with strong attention to detail.

Education

CS Degree - Computer Science

Tiraspol State University, Chișinău (Moldova) — Jan 2012 - Jan 2016